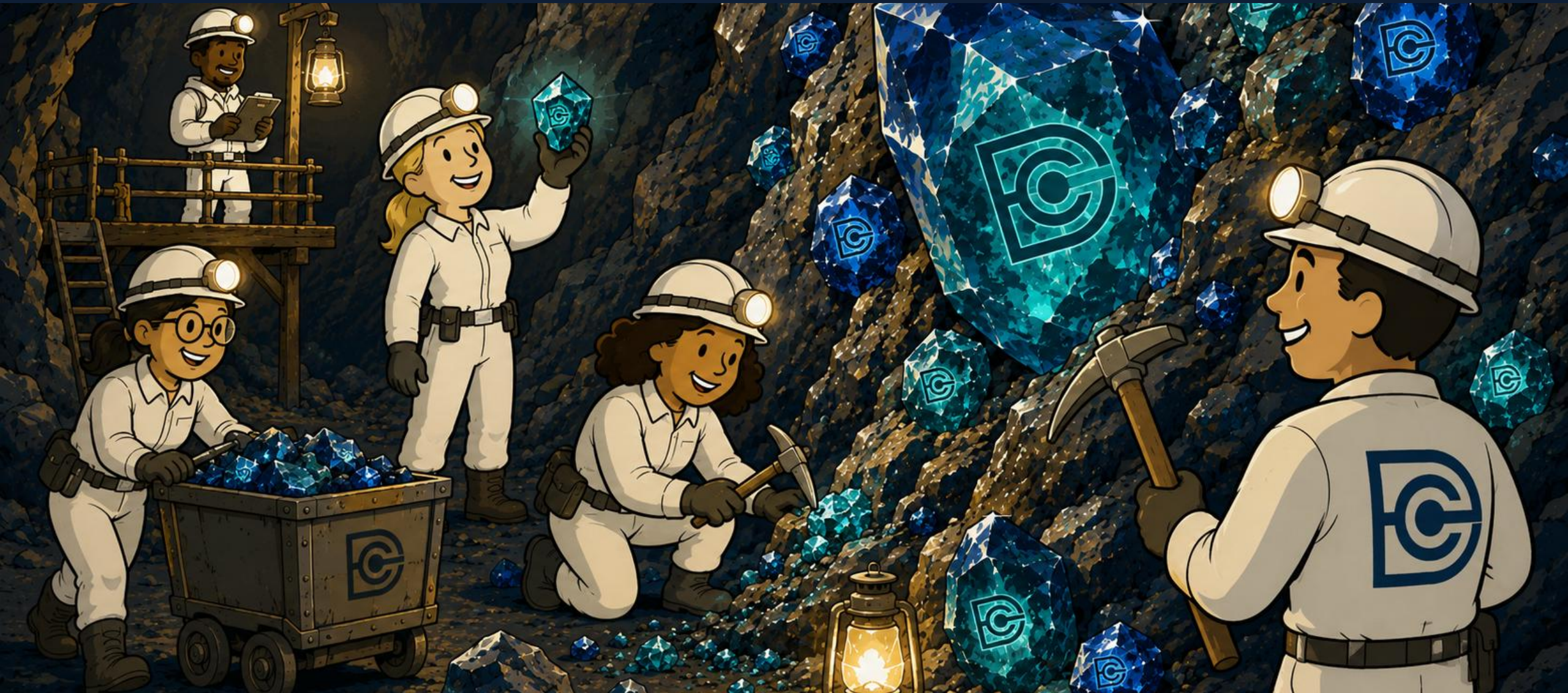


A Decade in Drama Research. Data Mining the DraCor Bibliography (2015–2025)



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What is DraCor, and why is it interesting to mine its bibliography?



Introducing DraCor

- DraCor is a digital research infrastructure for European drama and beyond from the Antiquity to present
- Showcase for the “programmable corpora” concept
- Core idea: make dramatic texts machine-readable, comparable, and interoperable
- Currently hosting 23 corpora in 21 languages – more than 4500 plays encoded in TEI-XML
- Open data, open source, community-driven development





DraCor – Open Infrastructure for Drama Analysis

Fre DraCor

French Drama Corpus

1,940

Number of plays

17,831

(M: 7958, F: 4247)

person + **personGrp**

Number of characters

text

17,701,440

Text tokens

509,958

(16,295,137)

sp

(Tokens)

48,755

(393,275)

stage

(Tokens)

dc9c208

Last update

14.7.2025, 06:35:29

Ger DraCor

German Drama Corpus

767

Number of plays

16,462

(M: 11632, F: 3430)

person + **personGrp**

Number of characters

text

11,969,043

Text tokens

472,952

(11,407,483)

sp

(Tokens)

225,126

(1,387,768)

stage

(Tokens)

e948b7c

Last update

19.2.2026, 08:35:23

Eng DraCor

English Drama Corpus

753

Number of plays

11,145

(M: 8564, F: 2080)

person + **personGrp**

Number of characters

text

16,448,904

Text tokens

550,693

(15,057,801)

sp

(Tokens)

97,646

(447,851)

stage

(Tokens)

dbc4fc6

Last update

1.2.2026, 22:14:19

Rus DraCor

Russian Drama Corpus

212

Number of plays

3,707

(M: 2608, F: 871)

person + **personGrp**

Number of characters

text

2,316,995

Text tokens

119,333

(2,191,657)

sp

(Tokens)

49,440

(215,112)

stage

(Tokens)

f602fad

Last update

1.2.2026, 16:39:25

Cal DraCor

Calderón Drama Corpus

205

Number of plays

3,406

(M: 1991, F: 1119)

person + **personGrp**

Number of characters

text

2,838,830

Text tokens

121,432

(2,736,034)

sp

(Tokens)

23,933

(115,495)

stage

(Tokens)

60316cb

Last update

1.2.2026, 02:54:39

ABOUT

[What Is DraCor?](#)
[Corpus Registry](#)
[Credits](#)
[Get in Touch](#)

DOCUMENTATION

[API](#)
[API v0 \(legacy\)](#)
[Encoding Guidelines \(ODD\)](#)
[FAQs](#)

TOOLS

[pydracor](#)
[rdracor](#)
[SPARQL](#)
[ezlinavis](#)

RESEARCH

[Research Bibliography](#)
[Posters](#)
[Card Games](#)
[DraCor in Science Communication](#)

DraCor API (standardised, structured access to all corpus data via URL queries)

DraCor API

1.0.2 OAS 3.0

/api/v1/openapi.yaml

[Terms of service](#)
[Contact the developer](#)
MIT

Servers

https://dracor.org/api/v1

public

GET

/info

API info

✓

GET

/corpora

List available corpora

✓

GET

/corpora/{corpusname}

List corpus content

✓

GET

/corpora/{corpusname}/metadata

List of metadata for all plays in a corpus

✓

GET

/corpora/{corpusname}/metadata/csv

List of metadata for all plays in a corpus

✓

GET

/corpora/{corpusname}/plays/{playname}

Get metadata and network metrics for a single play

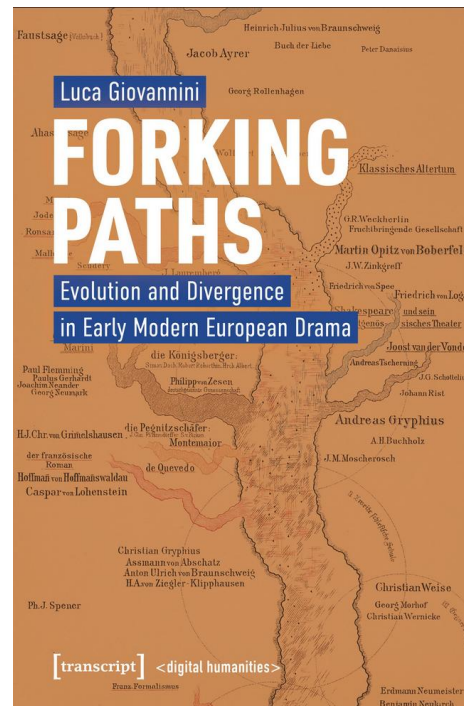
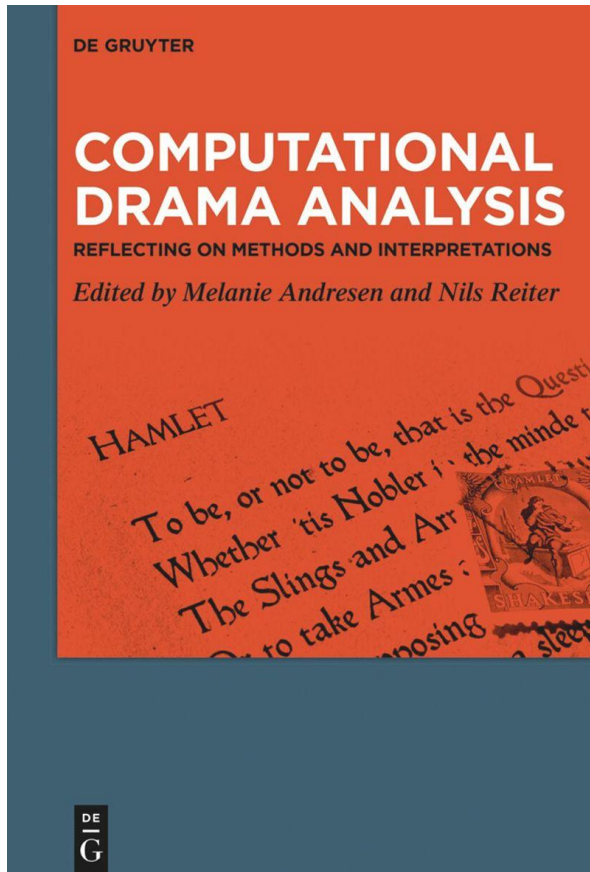
✓

DraCor community



Left: core DraCor team (Vienna, 2024).

Above: participants to the first DraCor Summit (Berlin, 2025)



Across the years, DraCor has become a key infrastructure for computational drama analysis — but how has it shaped the research community around it?



We mine the DraCor bibliography to understand which **topics**, **methods**, **tools**, and **scholars** have been shaping the field of computational drama analysis

Corpus & Methodology



- 114 papers from the DraCor bibliography (April 2025): journal articles, conference proceedings, book chapters
- Only works that actively use DraCor corpora or API (not mere mentions)
- Metadata:
 - Language: >50% in English, ~25% in German
 - Authorship: 35% written by teams of 3–5 authors
 - Most cited corpus: GerDraCor (35% of papers), followed by RusDraCor and FreDraCor

CS1: Semantic Space

Research question

- What is the semantic space of DraCor-related research? Do papers cluster by topic or method?

Method

- Full texts embedded with a multilingual transformer.
- Papers split into chunks, chunk embeddings mean-pooled into one vector per paper.
- PCA applied to reveal global structure across 114 papers in a language-agnostic way.

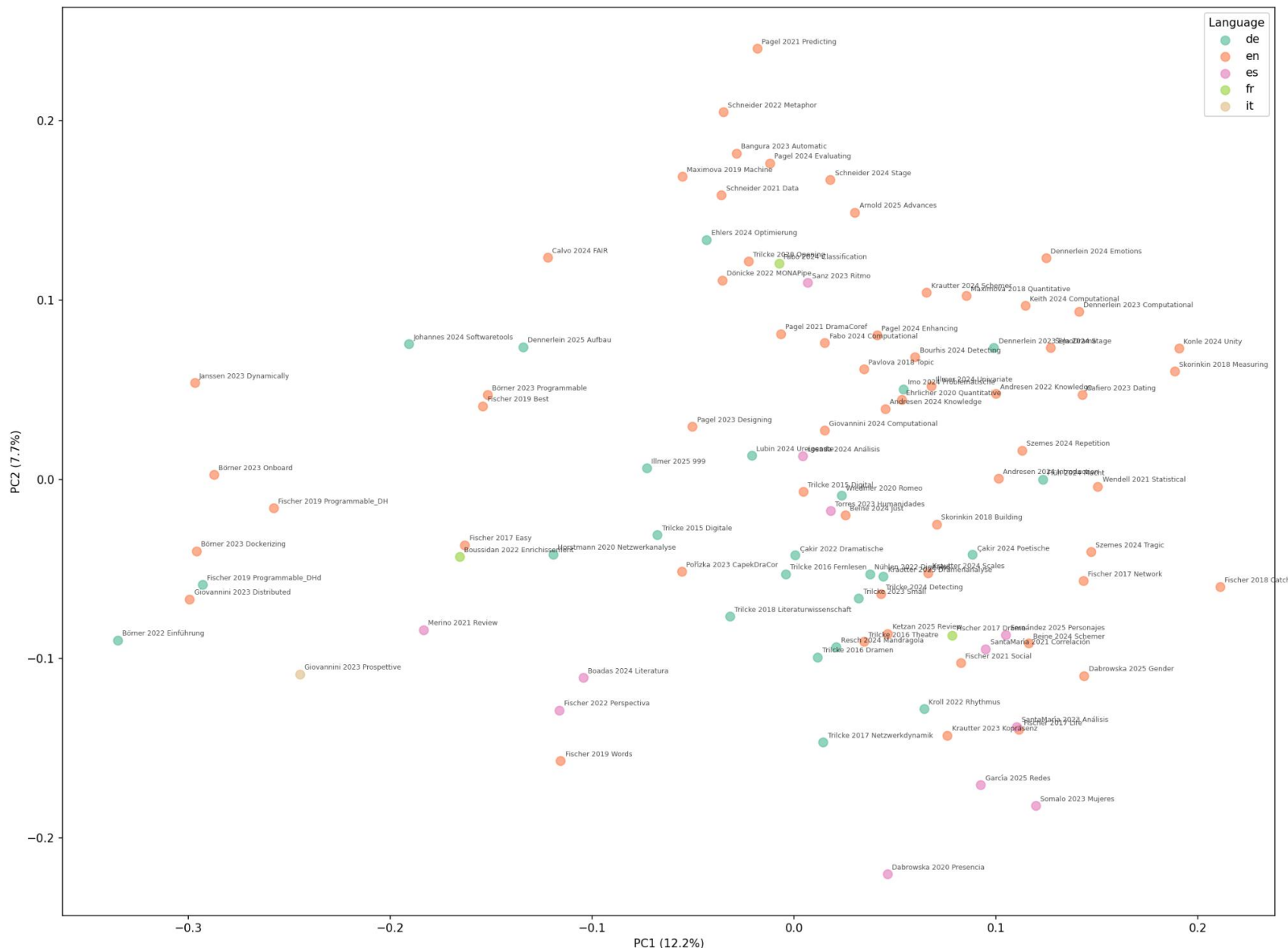
CS1: Results

Infrastructure vs. research divide (PC1)

- Left: infrastructure-oriented papers (DraCor platform, API). Right: papers using DraCor as data source for computational drama analysis.

Methodological gradient (PC2)

- Upper: ML-based papers (detection, classification). Lower: traditional quantitative / distant-reading approaches.



CS 2: Methods, Tools & Formats

Research question

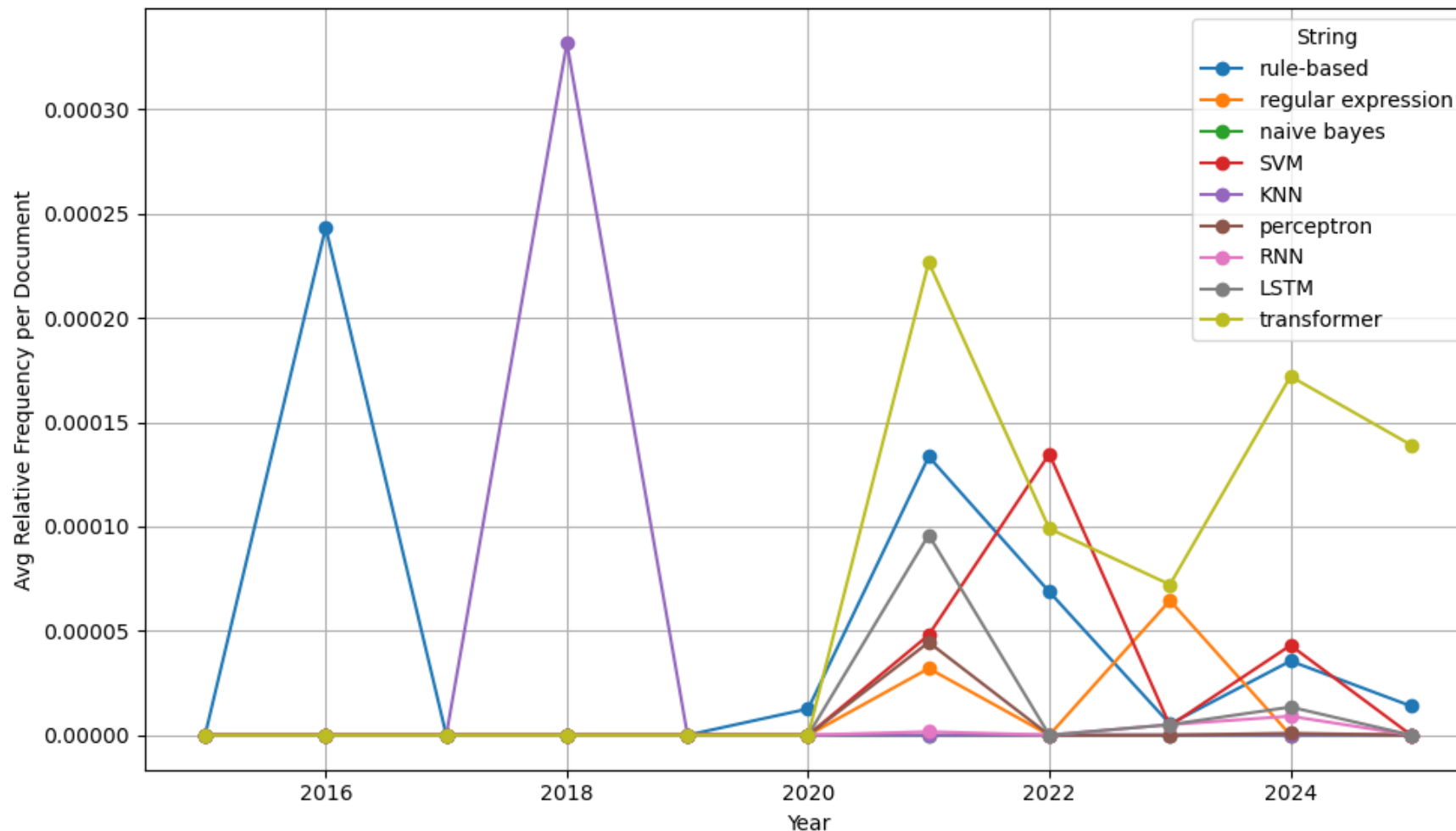
- What tools, formats, and methods recur across the DraCor bibliography? How have they evolved over time?

Method

- Multilingual word lists (Schöch, Fileva, Dudar 2022). String matching of n-grams (1–4 words), case-sensitive, accounting for spelling variants (e.g. lemmatisation/lemmatization) and translations.
- Counts aggregated per paper and diachronically to track trends 2015–2025.

CS 2: Results

- **Top formats** (>70% of papers): TEI, XML
- **Top tools:** Python (40%) and Github (30%) signal engagement with DraCor's programmable corpora concept.
 - API mentions peaked at dracor.org launch (2017).
- **Top methods:** annotation (45%), network analysis, classification, ML (30–40%)
 - Early papers used mainly network analysis; later contributions added classification and machine learning.



Algorithm shift
after 2021:
transformers
overtook
classical ML
and other
neural
architectures

CS 3: Citation Network

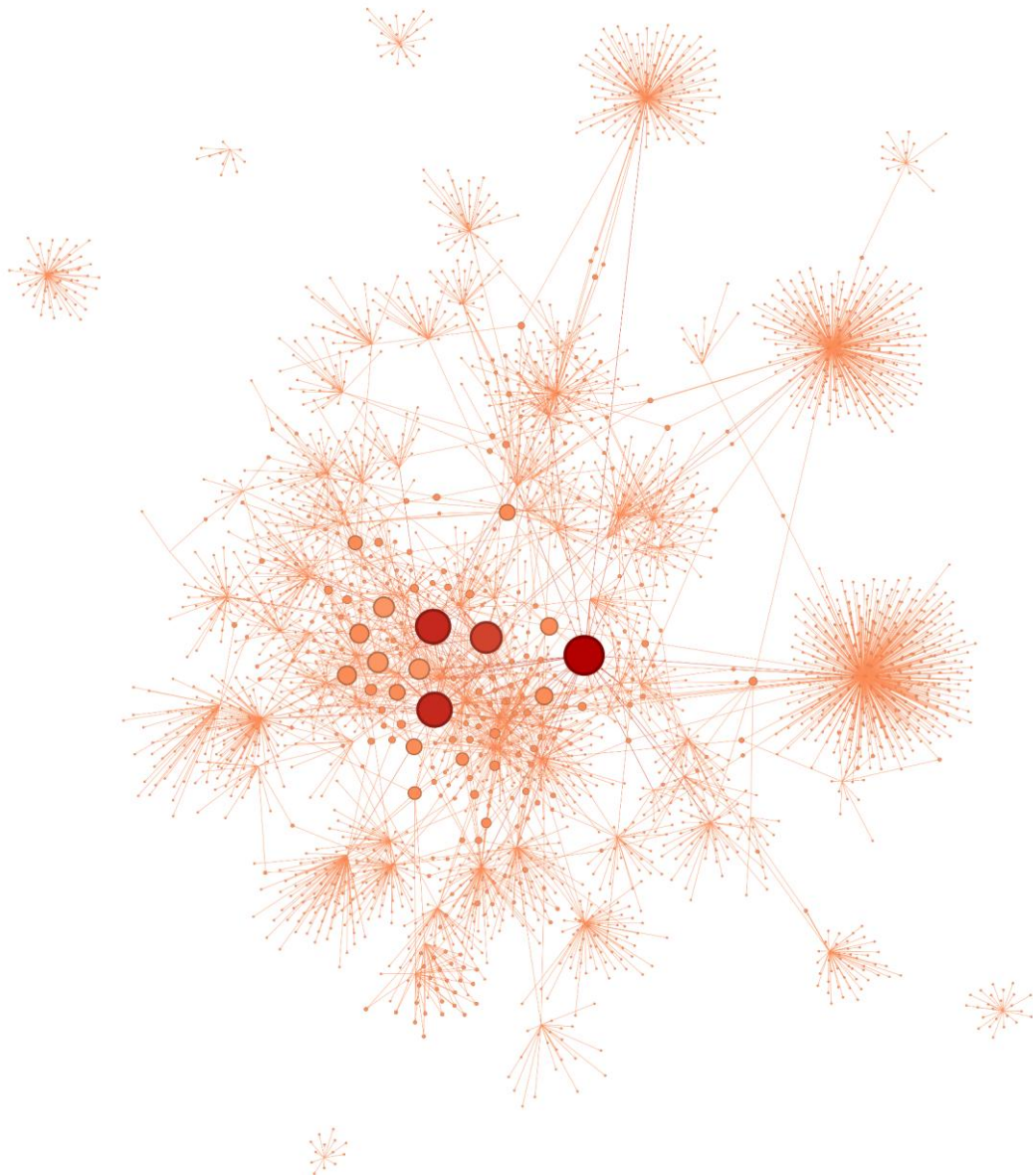
Research question

- Which other works are most influential within the DraCor bibliography? Can distinct research communities be identified?

Method

- Network of publications cited within items in the DraCor bibliography
 - 3,377 nodes (publications), edges = citation links
 - Node size scaled to in-degree (number of papers citing it).

CS 3: Citation Network — Results



Scale-free, hub-and-spoke topology

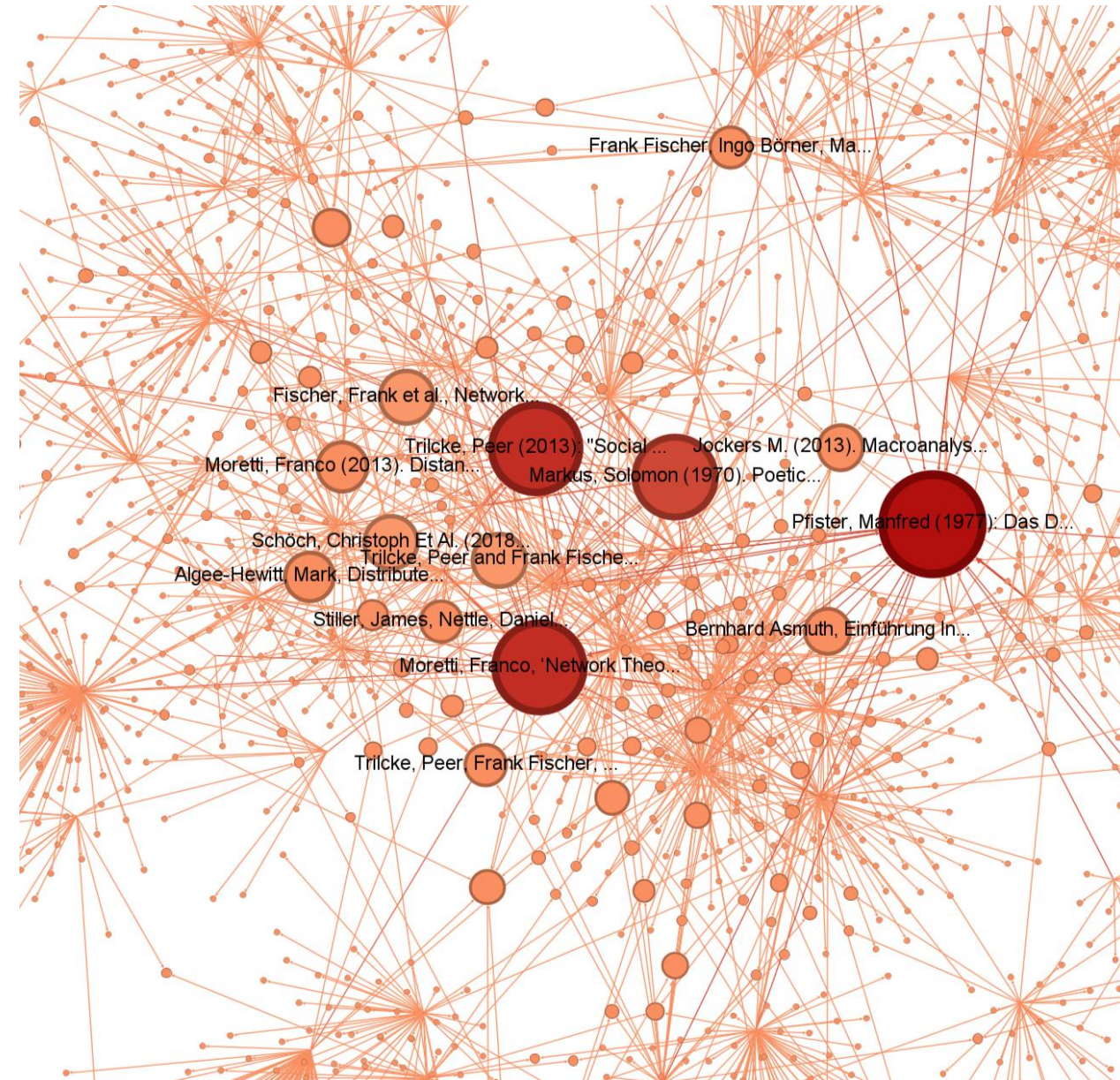
- Most papers have small citation clusters; a few highly-cited works become central hubs.

No major paradigm shifts: structuralist-formalist tradition dominates

- Most-cited: Pfister 1977, Marcus 1970 (early seminal works); Moretti 2011, Trilcke 2013 (literary network analysis).

Takeaway

- CDA has been methodologically responsive but theoretically stable, building on the same formalist foundations across a decade.



Findings & Outlook

DraCor scholarship has broadened over time

- Network analysis (early DraCor era) progressively flanked by diverse methods; DraCor is evolving into a versatile resource for digital literary studies

Stable theoretical core

- Citation network shows consolidated clusters of key structuralist references; no major paradigm shifts detected over 10 years

Next steps: DraCorOS project

- Ontology-based modelling (CIDOC-CRM extension), Zenodo self-reporting routine, Linked Open Data integration, knowledge graph for complex queries

A dark, rocky cave with glowing blue crystals and a mine cart. The cave is filled with jagged rock formations and numerous glowing blue crystals of various sizes. A mine cart with a 'C' logo is on tracks in the lower left. The text 'We are looking forward to your ideas and thoughts!' is centered in the upper half.

We are looking forward to your ideas and thoughts!

Contact: info@dracor.org

Bluesky: [@dracor.org](https://bsky.app/profile/@dracor.org)